

PATENTE B DICTIONARY

A-Z quiz vocabulary guide



Confusing Italian words explained simply

English meaning, simple explanation, and short examples for the most common Patente A/B quiz words.

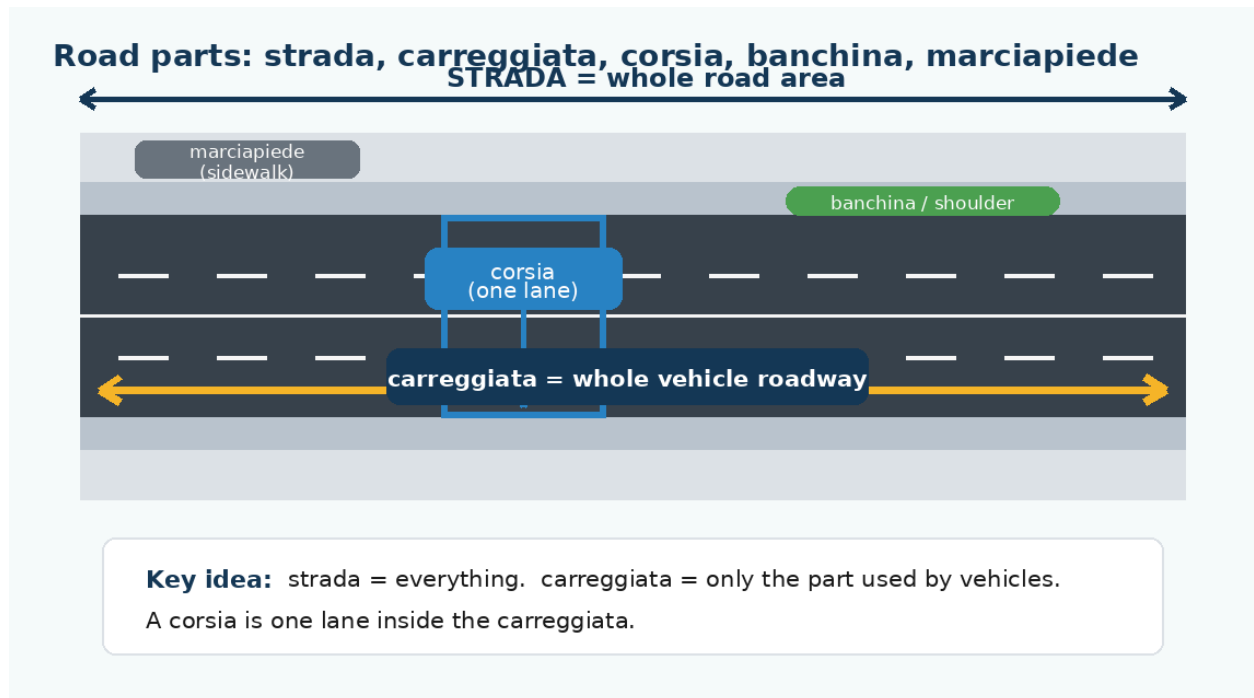
[A-Z words](#)

[Simple English](#)

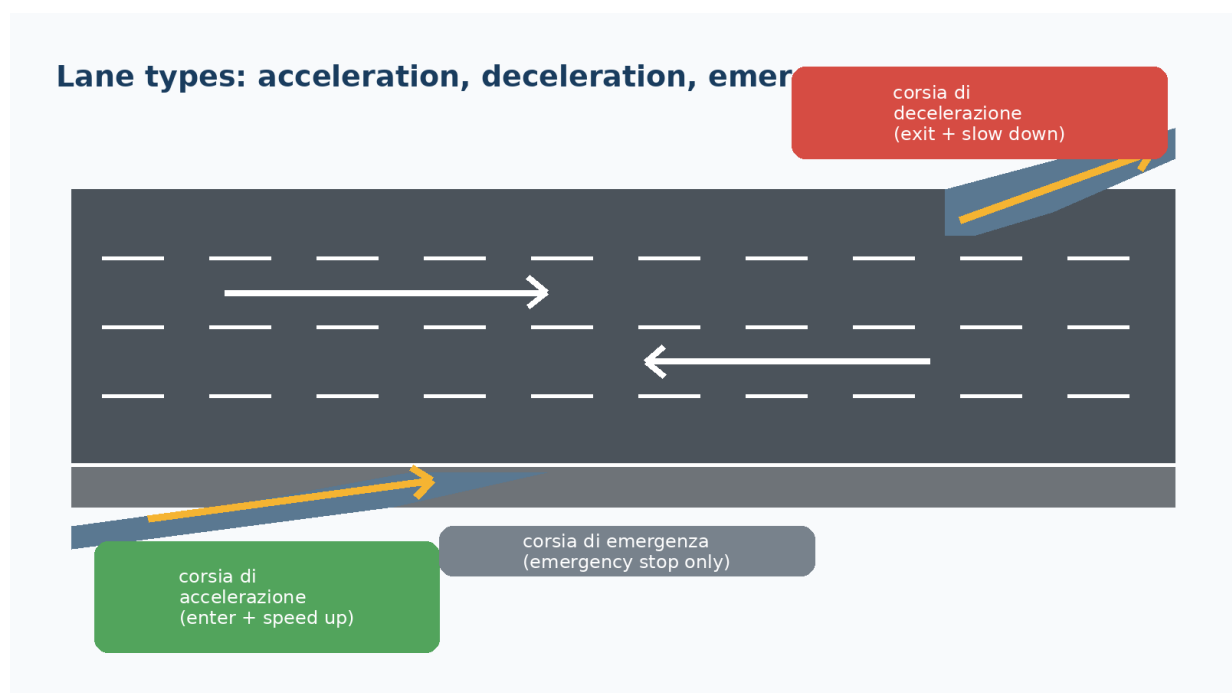
[Quiz examples](#)

Visual mini-guides

These simple diagrams are included because some concepts become much easier when students can see the difference.

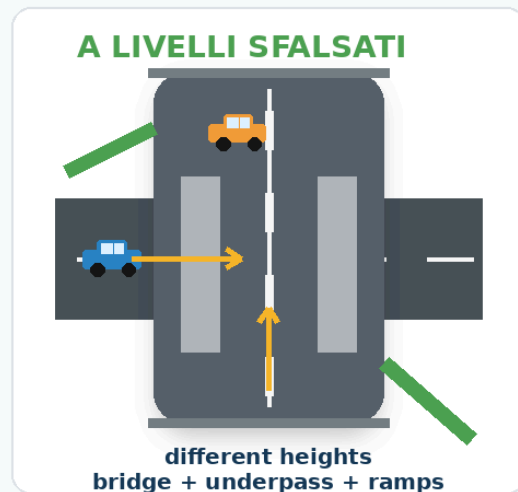


Strada vs carreggiata vs corsia vs banchina vs marciapiede



Acceleration, deceleration and emergency lanes

Incrocio a raso vs incrocio a livelli sfalsati



A raso = same level. Livelli sfalsati = different heights.

Arresto, fermata, sosta: three different stops



Arresto vs fermata vs sosta

Aderenza and braking distance

DRY ROAD - more grip



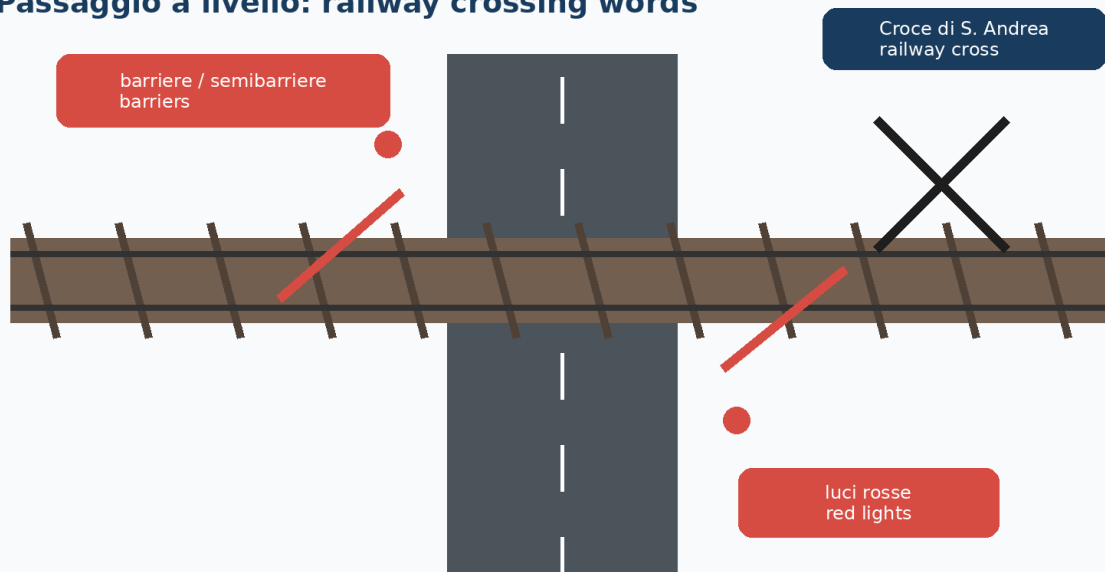
WET / OILY / SNOWY ROAD - less grip



Quiz idea: rain, snow, worn tyres, high speed and heavy load reduce grip and increase stopping

Aderenza and braking distance

Passaggio a livello: railway crossing words

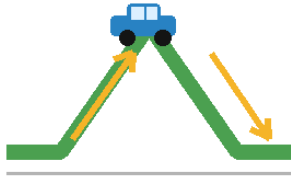


Level crossing signs and barriers

Dosso, cunetta and tornante

DOSSO

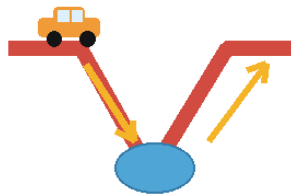
up then down



Hill crest.
Visibility can be limited.

CUNETTA

down then up



Dip / hollow.
Water, mud or debris can collect.

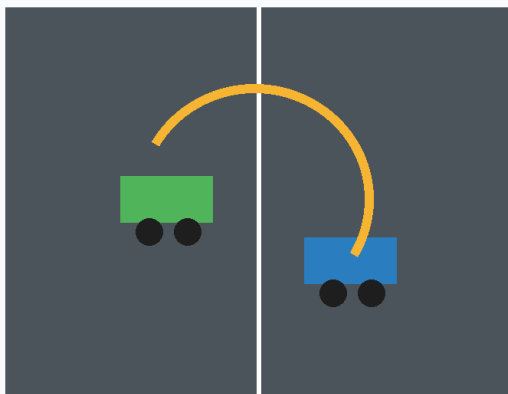
TORNANTE

tight U-bend

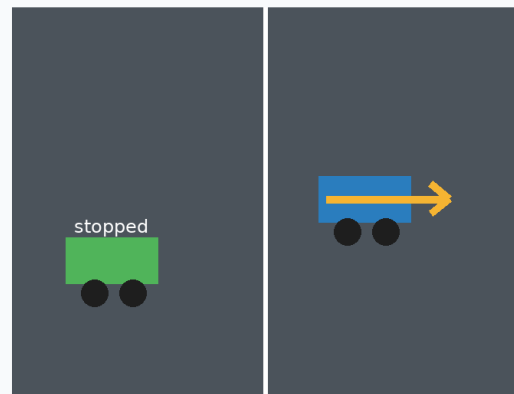


Very tight bend,
often on mountain roads.

Sorpasso vs superamento



SORPASSO: you move out and pass a moving vehicle



SUPERAMENTO: you pass an obstacle or stopped vehicle

Sorpasso vs superamento

A-Z dictionary

A

A doppio senso di circolazione

English meaning: two-way traffic

Explanation: Vehicles can travel in both directions on the same road/carriageway.

Example: La strada e a doppio senso: keep to the right and expect vehicles from the opposite direction.

Careful: Do not read it as two lanes. It means two directions.

A livelli sfalsati

English meaning: at different levels

Explanation: An intersection where roads cross at different heights using ramps, bridges or underpasses.

Example: Autostrade often have intersezioni a livelli sfalsati.

Image help: Visual guide: incrocio a raso vs livelli sfalsati

A raso

English meaning: at the same level

Explanation: Roads or areas meet on the same level, without bridges or underpasses.

Example: Un incrocio a raso is a normal crossroads where vehicles can cross directly.

Image help: Visual guide: incrocio a raso vs livelli sfalsati

A senso unico di circolazione

English meaning: one-way traffic

Explanation: Traffic is allowed in one direction only.

Example: In a senso unico street, all vehicles go the same direction.

Careful: One-way does not mean one lane.

Abbaglianti

English meaning: high beam headlights

Explanation: Strong headlights for dark roads; they can dazzle other drivers.

Example: Switch off gli abbaglianti when another vehicle comes from the opposite direction.

Careful: Do not confuse with anabbaglianti = dipped/low beam.

Accertamento

English meaning: official check / verification

Explanation: A formal check done by authorities, doctors or police.

Example: La visita medica is an accertamento of physical requirements.

Accostare

English meaning: to pull over / move close to the side

Explanation: To move the vehicle close to the right edge of the road or stop near the side.

Example: Accostare a destra means move close to the right side.

Adeguare la velocità

English meaning: to adapt speed

Explanation: To choose a safe speed based on road, traffic, weather, visibility and vehicle conditions.

Example: Adeguare la velocità in curva means slow enough for the curve.

Aderenza

English meaning: grip / traction

Explanation: The contact grip between tyres and the road. Less aderenza means more skidding and longer braking distance.

Example: Rain, snow, oil and worn tyres reduce aderenza.

Image help: Visual guide: aderenza and braking distance

Adibito a

English meaning: used for / intended for

Explanation: Shows the purpose of a vehicle or area.

Example: Un veicolo adibito al trasporto di persone = vehicle used to transport people.

Careful: Very similar to destinato a.

Affiancati

English meaning: side by side

Explanation: Two vehicles travelling next to each other on the same line.

Example: Due ciclomotori affiancati = two mopeds side by side.

Agenti del traffico

English meaning: traffic officers

Explanation: Police or authorized officers who regulate traffic. Their signals can override signs and traffic lights.

Example: If a traffic officer tells you to stop, you stop even if the light is green.

Agevolare

English meaning: to make easier / facilitate

Explanation: To help another road user complete a manoeuvre safely.

Example: Agevolare l'immissione means help another vehicle enter the traffic.

Airbag

English meaning: airbag

Explanation: A safety device that inflates during a crash to reduce injury.

Example: Seat belts must still be worn even if the car has airbags.

Alloggiare

English meaning: to lodge / stay in

Explanation: Used for caravans/campers: to stay or sleep inside.

Example: A caravan can be used as alloggio only when the vehicle is stopped.

Anabbaglianti

English meaning: dipped / low beam headlights

Explanation: Normal headlights used at night, in tunnels or poor visibility.

Example: Use gli anabbaglianti in galleria.

Careful: Do not confuse with abbaglianti = high beam.

Andatura

English meaning: pace / speed style

Explanation: The way or speed at which you drive.

Example: Andatura moderata = moderate, careful speed.

Apposito

English meaning: specific / suitable / provided for that purpose

Explanation: A word used in quizzes to mean the correct, dedicated sign, device or place.

Example: Apposito segnale = the specific sign required for that situation.

Arresto

English meaning: stop caused by traffic needs

Explanation: The vehicle stops because traffic requires it: red light, queue, stop sign, pedestrian crossing, etc.

Example: Stopping at a red traffic light is arresto.

Careful: Do not confuse with fermata or sosta.

Image help: Visual guide: arresto, fermata, sosta

Attraversamento ciclabile

English meaning: bicycle crossing

Explanation: Part of the carriageway where bicycles cross.

Example: At an attraversamento ciclabile, watch for cyclists crossing the road.

Attraversamento pedonale

English meaning: pedestrian crossing / zebra crossing

Explanation: Part of the carriageway where pedestrians cross and vehicles must give way.

Example: You cannot stop or park on an attraversamento pedonale.

Image help: Visual guide: road parts

Autocaravan

English meaning: camper / motorhome

Explanation: A motor vehicle designed for transport and accommodation.

Example: An autocaravan is not a rimorchio because it has its own motor.

Autostrada

English meaning: motorway / highway

Explanation: A major road with separate carriageways, no at-grade crossings, entry/exit lanes and limited vehicle categories.

Example: Ciclomotori cannot circulate on the autostrada.

Avaria

English meaning: breakdown / fault

Explanation: A technical problem that stops or makes the vehicle unsafe.

Example: If the car has avaria on a motorway, use hazard lights and the warning triangle.

Avvisatore acustico

English meaning: horn

Explanation: Device used to warn others in dangerous situations.

Example: Use the horn only when needed to avoid danger, not to greet friends.

B

Banchina

English meaning: road shoulder / side strip

Explanation: Part of the road outside the carriageway, beyond the edge line. Normally not for vehicle traffic.

Example: La banchina is outside the carreggiata, not inside it.

Careful: Common trap: banchina is part of the strada, but not part of the carreggiata.

Image help: Visual guide: road parts

Banchina cedevole

English meaning: soft / weak road shoulder

Explanation: A shoulder that may collapse or be unsafe if driven on.

Example: A banchina cedevole can make the vehicle lose control.

Barriera

English meaning: barriers

Explanation: Full barriers at a level crossing or road works.

Example: At a passaggio a livello, closed barriers mean you must stop.

Image help: Visual guide: passaggio a livello

Battistrada

English meaning: tyre tread

Explanation: The grooved outer part of the tyre that touches the road. It helps grip and water drainage.

Example: A worn battistrada increases aquaplaning risk.

Bollettino

English meaning: payment slip

Explanation: A payment document, often for fees or administrative procedures.

Example: You may need a bollettino for some Motorizzazione payments.

C

Caduta massi

English meaning: falling rocks

Explanation: Warning of stones or rocks that may fall onto the road.

Example: When you see caduta massi, reduce speed and avoid stopping near the cliff.

Cambio di corsia

English meaning: lane change

Explanation: Moving from one lane to another.

Example: Before changing lane, check mirrors and use indicators.

Canalizzazione / Incanalamento

English meaning: channeling traffic

Explanation: Road markings or islands that guide vehicles into the correct direction or lane.

Example: An isola di traffico can help incanalamento of vehicles.

Caravan

English meaning: caravan / trailer home

Explanation: A trailer fitted as accommodation; it has no engine and must be towed.

Example: You can stay inside a caravan only when the vehicle is stopped.

Carico

English meaning: load / cargo

Explanation: The things or goods transported by a vehicle.

Example: The carico must be placed safely and must not fall.

Carreggiata

English meaning: carriageway / roadway for vehicles

Explanation: The part of the road normally used by vehicles. It can contain one or more lanes.

Example: The carreggiata does not include the sidewalk or the shoulder.

Careful: Do not translate it as the whole road. The whole road is strada.

Image help: Visual guide: road parts

Carreggiata sdrucchiolevole

English meaning: slippery carriageway

Explanation: A road surface where grip is low because of water, ice, oil, mud or leaves.

Example: On a carreggiata sdrucchiolevole, avoid sudden braking and steering.

Image help: Visual guide: aderenza

Carta di circolazione

English meaning: vehicle registration document

Explanation: Document containing vehicle data, owner/holder details and allowed technical limits.

Example: Check the carta di circolazione for the maximum number of seats.

Casco

English meaning: helmet

Explanation: Protective helmet for motorcycles, mopeds and some quadricycles.

Example: Il casco must be fastened correctly.

Catadiottro

English meaning: reflector

Explanation: A reflector that returns light from headlights so the vehicle/object can be seen.

Example: Bicycles and trailers can have catadiottri.

Cedevole

English meaning: weak / likely to give way

Explanation: A surface that can collapse or not support weight.

Example: A banchina cedevole is dangerous for heavy vehicles.

Ciclomotore

English meaning: moped

Explanation: Usually a small motor vehicle up to 50 cm³ and limited speed.

Example: Not every two-wheel motor vehicle is a ciclomotore.

Cinture di sicurezza

English meaning: seat belts

Explanation: Safety belts that reduce injury in crashes.

Example: Cinture must be used by driver and passengers when required.

Collisione

English meaning: collision / crash

Explanation: Impact between vehicles or objects.

Example: A safe distance helps avoid collision.

Conducente

English meaning: driver

Explanation: The person driving or controlling the vehicle.

Example: The conducente is responsible for safe driving.

Consentito

English meaning: allowed / permitted

Explanation: The action is legal or possible.

Example: Se e consentito, you may do it; if vietato, you cannot.

Continuo / Striscia continua

English meaning: continuous line

Explanation: An unbroken line, usually meaning you must not cross it when it separates directions or lanes.

Example: Do not cross a striscia continua to overtake.

Corrispondenza, in

English meaning: at / exactly by / in line with

Explanation: Means exactly at that point or near the same position.

Example: In corrispondenza del passo carrabile = at the driveway access.

Corsia

English meaning: lane

Explanation: Part of the carriageway for one line of vehicles.

Example: A corsia can be for normal driving, overtaking, acceleration or deceleration.

Careful: A single corsia is not normally two-way.

Image help: Visual guide: road parts

Corsia di accelerazione

English meaning: acceleration lane

Explanation: Lane used to enter a motorway or main extra-urban road and reach traffic speed.

Example: Use the corsia di accelerazione to enter safely, not to overtake.

Image help: Visual guide: lane types

Corsia di decelerazione

English meaning: deceleration lane

Explanation: Lane used to leave a motorway or main extra-urban road while slowing down.

Example: Enter the corsia di decelerazione before reducing speed strongly.

Image help: Visual guide: lane types

Corsia di emergenza

English meaning: emergency lane

Explanation: Lane reserved for emergencies, breakdowns or rescue vehicles.

Example: Do not use the corsia di emergenza to avoid traffic.

Image help: Visual guide: lane types

Corsia di marcia

English meaning: driving lane

Explanation: Normal lane used to travel.

Example: On multi-lane roads, use the rightmost free corsia di marcia.

Corsia di sorpasso

English meaning: overtaking lane

Explanation: Lane used to pass slower vehicles.

Example: After overtaking, return to the right lane when possible.

Corsia riservata

English meaning: reserved lane

Explanation: Lane reserved for specified users such as buses, taxis or bicycles.

Example: A corsia riservata to buses cannot be used by normal cars unless allowed.

Corsia specializzata

English meaning: special-purpose lane

Explanation: Lane reserved for a specific manoeuvre, often turning, acceleration or deceleration.

Example: A lane for vehicles turning right is a corsia specializzata.

Corteo

English meaning: procession / convoy

Explanation: A group moving together, often with special rules.

Example: Do not cut through a funeral or official corteo when prohibited.

Croce di S. Andrea

English meaning: St Andrew cross at railway crossing

Explanation: Sign placed near a level crossing, especially without barriers, indicating the railway line.

Example: At the Croce di S. Andrea, stop if a train is approaching.

Image help: Visual guide: passaggio a livello

Cunetta

English meaning: dip / hollow in the road

Explanation: A down-up change in the road profile; water, mud or debris can collect there.

Example: In a cunetta, slow down to avoid losing control.

Image help: Visual guide: dosso, cunetta, curva

Curva pericolosa

English meaning: dangerous curve

Explanation: A bend with reduced visibility, small radius or other risk.

Example: Before a curva pericolosa, moderate speed and keep right.

Image help: Visual guide: dosso, cunetta, curva

D

Dare precedenza

English meaning: to give way / yield

Explanation: Let another road user pass before you.

Example: At a GIVE WAY sign, you must dare precedenza to traffic on the main road.

Deformata

English meaning: deformed / uneven

Explanation: A road surface that is irregular, damaged or not flat.

Example: A strada deformata requires moderate speed.

Delimitato

English meaning: marked / bounded

Explanation: Separated or indicated by lines, curbs, barriers or signs.

Example: A marciapiede may be rialzato or delimitato in another way.

Destinato a

English meaning: intended for / reserved for use

Explanation: Indicates the function of an area, lane or vehicle.

Example: Corsia destinata al sorpasso = lane intended for overtaking.

Detriti

English meaning: debris

Explanation: Small materials on the road such as stones, mud, broken glass or branches.

Example: After a storm, detriti can reduce grip.

Deviazione

English meaning: diversion / detour

Explanation: A temporary route when the normal road is closed or changed.

Example: Road works may require a deviazione.

Di norma

English meaning: normally / generally

Explanation: Means in the usual case, but exceptions may exist.

Example: Di norma, vehicles travel on the right.

Careful: Quiz trap: di norma is not always = always.

Diritto di precedenza

English meaning: right of way

Explanation: The right to pass before another vehicle.

Example: The main road often gives diritto di precedenza.

Discesa pericolosa

English meaning: dangerous downhill slope

Explanation: A steep downhill road where braking and speed control are important.

Example: Use a lower gear on a discesa pericolosa.

Discontinuo / Striscia discontinua

English meaning: broken line

Explanation: A dashed line that may be crossed if safe and allowed.

Example: You may cross a striscia discontinua to overtake if conditions allow.

Dispositivo

English meaning: device / equipment

Explanation: Any technical equipment on the vehicle or road.

Example: Indicators, lights and brakes are dispositivi.

Distanza di sicurezza

English meaning: safe following distance

Explanation: Space you must keep from the vehicle in front to avoid collision if it brakes.

Example: Increase distanza di sicurezza when the road is wet.

Divieto

English meaning: prohibition / ban

Explanation: A rule or sign that says you must not do something.

Example: Divieto di sorpasso = no overtaking.

Dosso

English meaning: bump / hill crest

Explanation: An up-down change of road level that can reduce visibility and stability.

Example: Before a dosso, slow down and avoid overtaking when visibility is limited.

Image help: Visual guide: dosso, cunetta, curva

Dotato di

English meaning: equipped with

Explanation: Means something has a specific device or equipment.

Example: Veicolo dotato di airbag = vehicle equipped with airbags.

E

Eccetto

English meaning: except

Explanation: Excludes a case from a rule.

Example: Divieto eccetto residenti = forbidden except residents.

Emissione zero

English meaning: zero emissions

Explanation: Vehicles that produce no exhaust emissions during use, usually electric.

Example: An area pedonale may allow zero-emission vehicles if expressly permitted.

Equipaggiamento

English meaning: equipment

Explanation: The devices and objects required or installed in a vehicle.

Example: Lights, triangle and tyres are part of vehicle equipaggiamento.

Escluso

English meaning: excluded / not included

Explanation: Means not part of the group.

Example: Autoveicoli are motor vehicles with at least four wheels, excluding quadricycles.

Eventuale

English meaning: possible / any

Explanation: Something that may happen or may be present.

Example: Watch for eventuali ostacoli means be ready for possible obstacles.

Extraurbana principale

English meaning: main extra-urban road

Explanation: A major road outside built-up areas, similar to a motorway but with different limits/signs.

Example: Ciclomotori cannot use strade extraurbane principali.

Extraurbana secondaria

English meaning: secondary extra-urban road

Explanation: A normal road outside towns, usually with lower speed limits than main extra-urban roads.

Example: On extraurban roads, adapt speed to curves and visibility.

F

Ferito / Ferita

English meaning: injured person / injury

Explanation: Someone hurt in a crash or an injury itself.

Example: A ferito must not be moved unless there is immediate danger.

Careful: Ferita can mean wound; ferito is the injured person.

Fermata

English meaning: short stop for people or brief need

Explanation: A temporary stop for passengers to get in/out or for very short needs.

Example: Stopping briefly to let a passenger out is fermata.

Careful: Fermata is allowed in more places than sosta, but not everywhere.

Image help: Visual guide: arresto, fermata, sosta

Fondo stradale

English meaning: road surface

Explanation: The actual surface of the road: dry, wet, icy, damaged, gravel, etc.

Example: Adjust speed to the fondo stradale.

Frenata

English meaning: braking

Explanation: The action of slowing/stopping with brakes.

Example: Avoid sudden frenata on slippery roads.

Freno di servizio

English meaning: service brake / main brake

Explanation: The normal brake used to slow or stop while driving.

Example: The foot brake is the freno di servizio.

Freno di stazionamento

English meaning: parking brake / handbrake

Explanation: Brake used to keep the vehicle stopped when parked.

Example: Use the freno di stazionamento when parking on a slope.

G

Galleria

English meaning: tunnel

Explanation: A covered road passage through a mountain/underground.

Example: In galleria, switch on dipped headlights and avoid stopping unless necessary.

Giubbotto retroriflettente

English meaning: reflective vest

Explanation: High-visibility vest used when outside the vehicle in emergencies.

Example: Wear the reflective vest before placing the warning triangle.

Guasto

English meaning: breakdown / malfunction

Explanation: A technical failure of the vehicle.

Example: In case of guasto, move safely and warn other road users.

Idoneo

English meaning: suitable / fit for use

Explanation: Safe and appropriate for the purpose.

Example: Pneumatici idonei are tyres suitable for the vehicle and season.

Immediatamente

English meaning: immediately

Explanation: Without delay.

Example: Stop immediately if a police officer orders it.

Immettersi

English meaning: to enter / merge into traffic

Explanation: To join a road or traffic flow from another road, lane, driveway or area.

Example: When you immetti on a main road, give way if required.

In caso di

English meaning: in case of

Explanation: Introduces a condition or situation.

Example: In caso di pioggia, increase the safety distance.

In prossimità

English meaning: near / close to

Explanation: Close to a place, but not exactly at it.

Example: In prossimità di un incrocio, slow down and be careful.

Careful: Corrispondenza = at the place; prossimità = near the place.

Infortunato

English meaning: injured person

Explanation: A person hurt in an accident.

Example: Do not give alcohol to an infortunato.

Ingombro

English meaning: obstruction / space occupied

Explanation: Something that blocks or occupies the carriageway.

Example: A broken-down vehicle creates ingombro sulla carreggiata.

Intersezione a livelli sfalsati

English meaning: grade-separated intersection

Explanation: Roads meet at different heights using ramps, bridges or tunnels.

Example: A motorway junction is often an intersezione a livelli sfalsati.

Image help: Visual guide: intersections

Intersezione a raso

English meaning: at-grade intersection

Explanation: Roads cross at the same level; vehicles can meet directly.

Example: A normal crossroads in town is usually a raso.

Image help: Visual guide: intersections

Intersezione / Incrocio

English meaning: intersection / crossroads

Explanation: Where two or more roads meet.

Example: At an incrocio, watch signs, signals and right-of-way rules.

Invadere la carreggiata

English meaning: to enter/occupy the carriageway

Explanation: To move into the part used by vehicles, often creating danger.

Example: A pedestrian can suddenly invade the carreggiata.

Inversione di marcia

English meaning: U-turn

Explanation: Turning the vehicle around to go in the opposite direction.

Example: Inversione di marcia is forbidden in many dangerous or low-visibility places.

Isola di traffico

English meaning: traffic island / painted island

Explanation: Road area used to guide traffic; vehicles must not drive over it. It can be painted or raised.

Example: Zebrature often mark an isola di traffico.

Lampeggiante

English meaning: flashing

Explanation: A light that switches on and off repeatedly.

Example: Luci rosse lampeggianti at a level crossing mean stop.

Limite massimo di velocità

English meaning: maximum speed limit

Explanation: The highest speed allowed. You may need to drive slower if conditions require.

Example: A 50 km/h sign is a limite massimo, not a target speed.

Limite minimo di velocità

English meaning: minimum speed limit

Explanation: The lowest speed required on a specific lane/road, if indicated.

Example: A lane may require a minimum speed for safe flow.

Luce gialla lampeggiante

English meaning: flashing yellow light

Explanation: Warns of danger or tells you to proceed carefully.

Example: A flashing yellow traffic light means go with caution.

Luce rossa

English meaning: red light

Explanation: Usually means stop.

Example: At a red traffic light you must stop before the stop line.

Luci di emergenza

English meaning: hazard warning lights

Explanation: All indicators flashing together to warn of danger or breakdown.

Example: Use hazard lights when your vehicle is stopped due to an emergency.

Luci di posizione

English meaning: position lights

Explanation: Lights that make the vehicle visible when parked or in low light, but do not illuminate the road.

Example: Position lights show where the vehicle is.

M

Macchine agricole

English meaning: agricultural machines

Explanation: Vehicles/machines used for agricultural work and transport connected to farms.

Example: Some agricultural machines can circulate on the road only if registered.

Macchine operatrici

English meaning: operating machines / work machines

Explanation: Machines used for construction, road works, snow clearing, etc.

Example: A snowplough can be a macchina operatrice.

Marciapiede

English meaning: sidewalk / pavement

Explanation: Part of the road outside the carriageway, usually raised or protected, reserved for pedestrians.

Example: Do not drive on the marciapiede.

Careful: It is part of the strada, but not part of the carreggiata.

Image help: Visual guide: road parts

Margine destro

English meaning: right edge

Explanation: The right side edge of the carriageway.

Example: On two-way roads, drive near the margine destro when required.

Massa a pieno carico

English meaning: maximum laden mass

Explanation: The maximum authorized mass of a vehicle when fully loaded.

Example: Trailer rules often depend on massa massima a pieno carico.

Mediante

English meaning: by means of / with

Explanation: Means using something.

Example: Segnalato mediante strisce bianche = marked with white lines.

Moderare la velocità

English meaning: to slow down / drive moderately

Explanation: Reduce speed and drive carefully because of danger, visibility, road surface or traffic.

Example: Moderare la velocità before a dangerous curve.

Motociclo

English meaning: motorcycle

Explanation: A motor vehicle with two wheels, generally above moped limits.

Example: A motorcycle is not the same category as a ciclomotore.

Motore termico

English meaning: combustion engine

Explanation: Engine that uses fuel such as petrol or diesel.

Example: A 50 cm³ motore termico is common in moped definitions.

Munito di

English meaning: provided with / equipped with

Explanation: Means the vehicle/sign/area has something.

Example: Passaggio a livello munito di barriere = crossing equipped with barriers.

N

Neopatentato

English meaning: newly licensed driver

Explanation: Driver who has recently obtained a licence and has special limits/rules.

Example: Some vehicles or speeds are restricted for neopatentati.

Non vedente

English meaning: blind person

Explanation: A person who cannot see. Road rules give special attention to them.

Example: Always stop for a non vedente crossing with a white cane.

O

Obbligo

English meaning: obligation / mandatory rule

Explanation: Something you must do.

Example: Obbligo di svolta a destra means you must turn right.

Oltre

English meaning: beyond / past

Explanation: After or outside a point/limit.

Example: Banchina is oltre the continuous edge line of the carriageway.

Omologato

English meaning: approved / certified

Explanation: Approved according to legal/technical standards.

Example: A helmet must be omologato.

Organi di polizia

English meaning: police authorities

Explanation: Police bodies authorized to regulate traffic and check documents.

Example: You must show documents when requested by organi di polizia.

Ostacolo

English meaning: obstacle

Explanation: Something that blocks or creates danger on the road.

Example: An unexpected ostacolo after a curve requires low speed.

Ostruire

English meaning: to obstruct / block

Explanation: To block passage, visibility or access.

Example: Do not park where you ostruisci a driveway or pedestrian crossing.

P

Pannelli distanziometrici

English meaning: distance marker panels

Explanation: Panels with diagonal red bars before a level crossing, showing you are approaching it.

Example: Three bars means farthest; one bar means closest to the crossing.

Image help: Visual guide: passaggio a livello

Pannello integrativo

English meaning: supplementary panel

Explanation: Small panel under a road sign that adds information: distance, length, time, category, exception.

Example: A danger sign with 300 m panel means the danger is 300 m ahead.

Parcheggio

English meaning: parking area / parking

Explanation: Area or action of leaving a vehicle.

Example: Parking in a reserved area without authorization is prohibited.

Passaggio a livello

English meaning: level crossing / railway crossing

Explanation: Place where a road crosses railway tracks at the same level.

Example: Never enter a level crossing if traffic prevents you from clearing it.

Image help: Visual guide: passaggio a livello

Passo carrabile

English meaning: driveway access

Explanation: Access from public road to private property or parking area. Parking is prohibited there.

Example: At a passo carrabile, fermata may be allowed but sosta is not.

Pavimentazione irregolare

English meaning: uneven road surface

Explanation: Surface not smooth or in bad condition.

Example: Slow down on pavimentazione irregolare.

Pedone

English meaning: pedestrian

Explanation: Person walking on the road/sidewalk.

Example: Drivers must give way to pedestrians on zebra crossings.

Pericolo

English meaning: danger / hazard

Explanation: A situation that can cause accident or injury.

Example: A triangular warning sign usually announces pericolo.

Piazzola di sosta

English meaning: lay-by / stopping bay

Explanation: Small area outside the carriageway where vehicles can stop.

Example: On some roads you may stop in a piazzola di sosta in emergency.

Pista ciclabile

English meaning: cycle path / bicycle lane

Explanation: Road area reserved for bicycles, usually separated or marked.

Example: Cars cannot normally drive on a pista ciclabile.

Pneumatici

English meaning: tyres

Explanation: Rubber parts that touch the road; condition affects grip, braking and stability.

Example: Check tyre pressure and tread regularly.

Image help: Visual guide: aderenza

Preannuncia / Presegnala

English meaning: announces in advance / warns before

Explanation: A sign tells you that something is coming ahead, not necessarily exactly there.

Example: A danger sign usually preannuncia the danger before you reach it.

Careful: Preannuncia = ahead. Indica can mean here/at this point.

Precedenza

English meaning: priority / right of way

Explanation: The rule deciding who passes first.

Example: At intersections, signs or right-hand rule decide precedenza.

Prescrizione

English meaning: regulatory instruction

Explanation: A sign/rule that gives an order: obligation, prohibition, priority.

Example: Divieto and obbligo signs are segnali di prescrizione.

Prossimità, in

English meaning: near

Explanation: Close to a point but not necessarily on it.

Example: In prossimità di un passaggio a livello, be ready to stop.

Protrarsi

English meaning: to continue / last longer

Explanation: Used mainly for parking or stops lasting beyond a time.

Example: La sosta non deve protrarsi oltre il tempo consentito.

Prudenza

English meaning: caution

Explanation: Careful behavior to avoid danger.

Example: Use prudenza near schools, pedestrian crossings and poor visibility.

Purché

English meaning: provided that / only if

Explanation: Introduces a condition that must be true.

Example: You may do it purché it does not create danger = only if it creates no danger.

Q

Quadriciclo

English meaning: quadricycle / light four-wheeled motor vehicle

Explanation: A four-wheeled motor vehicle category separate from normal cars.

Example: Light quadricycles are treated differently from cars.

Qualora

English meaning: if / whenever

Explanation: Formal word meaning se.

Example: Qualora sia necessario = if it is necessary.

R

Raffigurato

English meaning: shown in the picture

Explanation: Refers to the image in the quiz. You must look at the picture, not only the sentence.

Example: Il segnale raffigurato = the sign shown in the image.

Rallentare

English meaning: to slow down

Explanation: Reduce speed.

Example: Rallentare before a curve or pedestrian crossing.

Rampe

English meaning: ramps

Explanation: Connecting roads used to enter/exit roads at different levels.

Example: Intersections at different levels include rampe.

RCA

English meaning: third-party motor insurance

Explanation: Responsabilità Civile Auto: compulsory insurance for damage caused to others.

Example: Driving without RCA is prohibited.

Regolare la velocità

English meaning: to adjust speed

Explanation: To choose speed according to limits and conditions.

Example: Regolare la velocità according to traffic, visibility and road surface.

Responsabilità civile

English meaning: civil liability

Explanation: Legal responsibility to compensate damage caused to others.

Example: RCA covers civil liability for road accidents.

Responsabilità penale

English meaning: criminal liability

Explanation: Legal responsibility for criminal offences, such as serious injury caused by unsafe driving.

Example: A driver can have penale responsibility after a serious accident.

Restringimento

English meaning: narrowing

Explanation: A road becomes narrower.

Example: A restringimento may require giving way to oncoming traffic.

Retromarcia

English meaning: reverse gear / reversing

Explanation: Moving the vehicle backward.

Example: Retromarcia is dangerous near intersections and must be done carefully.

Retronebbia

English meaning: rear fog light

Explanation: Strong rear red light used in fog or poor visibility.

Example: Do not use rear fog lights when visibility is good.

Revisione

English meaning: periodic inspection / roadworthiness test

Explanation: Official vehicle check to confirm it is safe and legal.

Example: Cars usually undergo revisione after four years, then every two years.

Rialzato

English meaning: raised

Explanation: Physically higher than the road level.

Example: A marciapiede may be rialzato.

Rimorchio

English meaning: trailer

Explanation: Vehicle without its own engine, designed to be towed.

Example: A caravan is a type of rimorchio.

Riservato

English meaning: reserved

Explanation: Only for specific users or vehicles.

Example: A lane riservata agli autobus is only for buses unless exceptions apply.

Rotatoria

English meaning: roundabout

Explanation: Circular intersection where vehicles travel around a central island.

Example: In a rotatoria, use indicators when exiting.

Ruotino

English meaning: space-saver spare wheel

Explanation: Temporary spare wheel; drive slowly and carefully when using it.

Example: With the ruotino, keep moderate speed especially in curves.

S

Sbandamento

English meaning: skidding / loss of control

Explanation: Vehicle slides or swerves, often due to poor grip, speed or sudden movements.

Example: Icy roads increase risk of sbandamento.

Image help: Visual guide: aderenza

Scarsa visibilità

English meaning: poor visibility

Explanation: When you cannot see well because of fog, rain, darkness, curves, hills or obstacles.

Example: With scarsa visibilità, slow down and increase distance.

Sdruciolevole

English meaning: slippery

Explanation: Describes a road surface with low grip.

Example: A sdruciolevole road requires gentle braking and steering.

Segnalare

English meaning: to signal / warn

Explanation: Use lights, indicators, horn or triangle to inform others.

Example: Signal a lane change with indicator lights.

Semaforo

English meaning: traffic light

Explanation: Light signal regulating traffic and pedestrians.

Example: Green allows you to proceed if the junction is clear.

SemibARRIERE

English meaning: half-barriers

Explanation: Half barriers at level crossings. They block only part of the road.

Example: Never pass around closed semibARRIERE.

Image help: Visual guide: passaggio a livello

Semirimorchio

English meaning: semi-trailer

Explanation: Trailer that rests partly on the tractor unit.

Example: A semirimorchio is different from a simple trailer.

Senso opposto

English meaning: opposite direction

Explanation: Traffic coming from the other direction.

Example: Watch for vehicles from senso opposto when overtaking.

Sgomberare

English meaning: to clear / move away from

Explanation: To free an area or leave it unobstructed.

Example: Do not enter a level crossing if you cannot sgomberarlo.

Soccorso

English meaning: rescue / first aid

Explanation: Help given in an emergency.

Example: Call emergency services and protect the area before soccorso.

Sorpasso

English meaning: overtaking

Explanation: Passing a moving vehicle by changing position/lane, usually on the left.

Example: Do not sorpassare near dangerous curves with poor visibility.

Careful: Different from superamento of a stopped vehicle or obstacle.

Image help: Visual guide: sorpasso vs superamento

Sosta

English meaning: parking / longer stop

Explanation: Suspension of driving for a longer time, usually with the vehicle left parked.

Example: Leaving the car for 20 minutes is sosta.

Careful: Sosta is more restrictive than fermata.

Image help: Visual guide: arresto, fermata, sosta

Sosta di emergenza

English meaning: emergency stop

Explanation: Stopping because of breakdown, illness or serious need.

Example: Use hazard lights and warning triangle during sosta di emergenza.

Spartitraffico

English meaning: traffic divider / central reservation

Explanation: Part separating carriageways or directions of traffic.

Example: A motorway has separate carriageways divided by spartitraffico.

Spazio di arresto

English meaning: stopping distance

Explanation: Total distance needed to stop: reaction distance + braking distance.

Example: At higher speed, spazio di arresto increases a lot.

Spazio di frenatura

English meaning: braking distance

Explanation: Distance travelled from when brakes start acting until the vehicle stops.

Example: Wet roads increase spazio di frenatura.

Spia

English meaning: dashboard warning light

Explanation: Light on the dashboard showing a system status or fault.

Example: A red oil pressure spia means stop safely and check.

Sporgenza

English meaning: projection / protruding load

Explanation: Part of the load sticking out from the vehicle shape.

Example: A rear sporgenza must be signalled correctly.

Stabilità

English meaning: stability

Explanation: How well the vehicle stays controlled and balanced.

Example: Load, tyre pressure and speed affect stability.

Strada

English meaning: road as a whole

Explanation: The complete road area open to pedestrians, animals and vehicles. It can include carriageway, shoulders, sidewalks and cycle paths.

Example: A strada can include marciapiedi and banchine.

Careful: Strada is wider than carreggiata.

Image help: Visual guide: road parts

Strisce longitudinali

English meaning: longitudinal road markings

Explanation: Lines running along the road direction.

Example: Longitudinal lines can separate lanes or road edges.

Superamento

English meaning: passing a stopped vehicle/obstacle

Explanation: Going past a stationary vehicle or obstacle, not necessarily a normal overtaking manoeuvre.

Example: Passing a parked car is often superamento, not sorpasso.

Image help: Visual guide: sorpasso vs superamento

Svolta / Svoltare

English meaning: turn / to turn

Explanation: Changing direction left or right at a junction or road.

Example: Signal before you svoltare.

T

Targa

English meaning: number plate / licence plate

Explanation: Vehicle identification plate.

Example: Vehicles must normally have a targa visible and valid.

Tempo di reazione

English meaning: reaction time

Explanation: Time between seeing a danger and starting to act, such as braking.

Example: Alcohol, tiredness and distraction increase reaction time.

Temporaneo

English meaning: temporary

Explanation: Valid only for a limited time, often road works or temporary signs.

Example: Yellow road markings can be temporary in roadworks.

Tenere saldamente il volante

English meaning: hold the steering wheel firmly

Explanation: Instruction used for rough roads, wind or possible skidding.

Example: On a road with potholes, hold the wheel firmly.

Tornante

English meaning: hairpin bend

Explanation: Very tight curve, common on mountain roads.

Example: Before a tornante, slow down and keep right.

Image help: Visual guide: dosso, cunetta, curva

Trainare / Traino

English meaning: to tow / towing

Explanation: Pulling another vehicle or trailer.

Example: An autovettura can tow a trailer if permitted by its documents.

Transito

English meaning: passage / movement through

Explanation: The act of passing through an area.

Example: Transito vietato means vehicles cannot pass through.

Tratto

English meaning: stretch / section

Explanation: A portion of road.

Example: Un tratto di strada deformata = a section of uneven road.

U

Uscita

English meaning: exit

Explanation: Place or manoeuvre for leaving a road, motorway, roundabout or area.

Example: Use the deceleration lane for motorway exit.

Ustione

English meaning: burn

Explanation: Injury caused by heat, chemicals or electricity.

Example: In first aid, do not apply random substances to a burn.

Utenti deboli

English meaning: vulnerable road users

Explanation: Road users more exposed to injury: pedestrians, cyclists, children, elderly and disabled people.

Example: Slow down near pedestrians and cyclists because they are utenti deboli.

V

Veicolo fermo

English meaning: stopped vehicle

Explanation: A vehicle not moving, for any reason.

Example: A vehicle fermo on the road can be an obstacle.

Veicolo in avaria

English meaning: broken-down vehicle

Explanation: Vehicle stopped or unsafe because of technical fault.

Example: Place the warning triangle behind a vehicle in avaria when required.

Velocità commisurata

English meaning: speed matched to conditions

Explanation: Speed must suit traffic, visibility, road, weather, vehicle and load.

Example: Even below the limit, speed can be unsafe if not commisurata.

Vigile

English meaning: traffic police officer

Explanation: Officer controlling traffic. In quizzes, vigile signals are important.

Example: A vigile standing with arms out can order vehicles to stop or pass.

Visibilità

English meaning: visibility

Explanation: How far and clearly you can see.

Example: With reduced visibility, slow down and avoid risky overtaking.

Z

Zebrature

English meaning: zebra-style painted markings

Explanation: Diagonal/striped markings, often on traffic islands or roadworks areas.

Example: Vehicles must not drive over zebrature of an isola di traffico.

Zona a traffico limitato (ZTL)

English meaning: limited traffic zone

Explanation: Area where only authorised vehicles/users may enter, often at certain times.

Example: In a ZTL, check signs and time restrictions before entering.

Fast trap pairs

These are the pairs students often confuse in the quiz.

Pair	Difference	Memory trick
Strada vs carreggiata	Strada is the whole road area. Carreggiata is only the part normally used by vehicles.	STRADA = big container; CARREGGIATA = vehicle part.
Corsia vs carreggiata	A corsia is one lane. A carreggiata can have one or more lanes.	Lane inside carriageway.
Banchina vs carreggiata	Banchina is outside the carriageway, beyond the edge line.	Banchina = side shoulder.
Marciapiede vs banchina	Marciapiede is for pedestrians and usually raised/protected. Banchina is road shoulder.	Pedestrians walk on marciapiede.
Fermata vs sosta vs arresto	Fermata = brief voluntary stop. Sosta = parking/longer stop. Arresto = traffic forces you to stop.	Fermata = quick; sosta = parked; arresto = traffic.
A raso vs livelli sfalsati	A raso = same level. Livelli sfalsati = different heights with ramps/bridges/underpasses.	Raso = flat.
Preannuncia vs indica	Preannuncia warns before. Indica can point to the exact place or give information.	Pre = before.
Sorpasso vs superamento	Sorpasso usually passes a moving vehicle. Superamento often passes a stopped vehicle/obstacle.	Sorpasso = overtaking.
Abbaglianti vs anabbaglianti	Abbaglianti = high beam. Anabbaglianti = low/dipped beam.	A-nabbaglianti are less dazzling.
Consentito vs vietato	Consentito = allowed. Vietato = forbidden.	Con-sentito = you can.
Di norma vs sempre	Di norma means normally; exceptions may exist. Sempre means always.	Norma is not absolute.
Purché vs qualora	Purché = provided that/only if. Qualora = if/when.	Purché gives a condition.